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Minogue's pledge stirs self-interest concerns

Candidate vows to allow flavored pouches of nicotine as he holds stock of key firm

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Michael Minogue, the Republican nominee for Massachusetts governor, has built a somewhat quixotic plank into his campaign: Legalize the sale of flavored nicotine pouches — and in particular one brand, ZYN.

He posted a video on social media pledging to “deregulate the sale of ZYNs.” His campaign sells a T-shirt emblazoned with an image that resembles a can of ZYN, but adorned with political slogans. Massachusetts banned the sale of flavored tobacco products more than

six years ago, but Minogue says he “will allow” the flavored nicotine pouches to return.

“It’s more freedom for you,” Minogue says in his video.

But what Minogue doesn’t mention is that he could benefit financially if the flavored nicotine products ZYN sells are allowed to return to Massachusetts store shelves.

A financial disclosure Minogue filed with state regulators shows he,

either directly or through a business, owns stock in some of the industry’s biggest tobacco companies, including Philip Morris International, which through a subsidiary owns ZYN.

Minogue is a former medical device industry executive who made a fortune when Abiomed, the Danvers-based company he ran, was sold in 2022. He reported holding a

MINOGUE, Page A7

T’s fixes on access will need fixing

Agency, disabled riders want changes now before new Green Line cars

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

In the next five years, the MBTA expects to make all but two stations along the Green Line ADA-accessible as part of a radical and costly transformation of the oldest branch of the system.

After all that work is done, though, the agency will face another reality: It will have to redo a lot of it.

The upcoming arrival of new Green Line trolleys is putting the T in a sticky position. It’s already investing hundreds of millions to expand or add platforms on the B, C, and E branches, but those platforms won’t be tall enough to allow riders with disabilities to board, without help, the more than 100 incoming “supercars” — the first of which will officially hit the tracks next year.

Eventually, Green Line riders will have to live through an additional bout of construction and shutdowns as the T reworks the platforms to make their height compatible with the so-called Type 10 cars.

It’ll require another pool of public money, and riders with disabilities who can board Green Line trains independently at some stations this year may later again need drivers’ assistance getting on and off with powered ramps, until the T can lift its platforms another 6 inches to align with

ACCESS, Page A10

OF FLOWERS, SNOWFLAKES, AND SUGAR PLUM FAIRIES



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Kendall Jean danced with other 6- and 7-year olds auditioning Saturday for The Jose Mateo Ballet Theatre’s “Nutcracker” production at the Mateo studio in Cambridge. Dozens of children from different age groups skipped, and pirouetted, and danced. The first show at the Strand Theatre in Dorchester is Dec. 5. **B1.**

A makeshift course of action by bicyclists

Duct-tape lane signals frustration

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The death this summer of a prominent cycling advocate and city worker, who was hit by a recycling truck as she rode her bicycle on a busy road in Mission Hill, sparked a public outcry over persistent safety issues and delayed street improvement efforts.

Late last month, it appears someone took matters into their own hands, an act of practical resistance that symbolized the cycling community’s frustration.

At the intersection of Tremont and Parker streets, duct tape was used to create a makeshift bike lane near the spot where Louisa Gag, 36, was fatally struck, filling a gap between two existing bike lanes, which are both unprotected.

In an anonymous note posted to a nearby pole, the protesters who created the lane said it was meant as a practical response to improve biker safety and to raise awareness about stalled infrastructure improvements under Mayor Michelle Wu.

But after a man riding an electric scooter was struck by a

BIKES, Page A10

Call it gritty and a bit ugly. Call it, also, a victory.

Patriots take home opener but offense was, again, lost

CHRISTOPHER L. GASPER

FOXBOROUGH — The Patriots’ home opener served as yet another reminder that the pixie dust that dotted last season’s run to the Super Bowl is gone, swept up into the dustbin of the past. It’s a new season and a new struggle for New England’s favorite football sons — emphasis on the struggle.

On a dishwater-gray Sunday at Gillette Stadium, they scored their first win of the 2026 season in a fashion more gritty than pretty. The Patriots upended the Pittsburgh Steelers, 20-3, evening their record at 1-1. No one was going to ruin coach Mike Vrabel’s day with caveats and concerns. He stiff-armed a postgame question in that vein.

But the triumph, their first home-opener win

since 2020, failed to provide the requisite reassurance about quarterback Drake Maye and an offense that has failed to launch so far. The Patriots only scored 13 points offensively after managing a meager 10 in their meltdown season-opening loss to the Seahawks.

Their New Year’s Day wasn’t Jan. 1. It was Sept. 9 in Seattle. Young Maye and the Patriots are learning that success in the NFL isn’t static, despite how elementary their Foxborough forebears, led by Tom Brady and Bill Belichick, made it look. It must be re-engineered and re-earned every season. These aren’t feel-good NFL up-and-comers any longer. They’re a team with high expectations and a target on their collective back.

“Yeah, it is tough in this league. It is tough. We

PATRIOTS, Page C6



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

For the Patriots, defense was the name of the game Sunday in Foxborough. Safety Kevin Byard and linebacker Robert Spillane did their part, putting the squeeze on Steelers running back Jaylen Warren in the fourth quarter.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patrick Clancy testified during the murder trial of his ex-wife, Lindsay Clancy, at Plymouth Superior Court on July 29.

Clancy talks of forgiveness, grief, starting new family

Subject of ‘60 Minutes’ interview with his wife

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

Patrick Clancy and his wife, Rachel Danis, are starting a family, he revealed in an interview with “60 Minutes” on Sunday, as they spoke publicly together for the first time about rebuilding his life after the deaths of his three children.

In the interview, Clancy said he looks forward to telling his future child about Cora, Dawson, and Callan, who were killed by his former wife, Lindsay Clancy, in their Duxbury home in January, 2023.

“I think every parent can agree, you have different relationships with your kids, but they’re all your kids, and I can’t wait to tell them about their brothers and sister,” he said.

When asked if Lindsay Clancy had asked for his forgiveness, he said she hadn’t.

“But I gave it to her,” he said.

The comments came during Clancy’s first interview since Lindsay Clancy’s murder trial ended

CLANCY, Page A7

A fade, then fall

Monday: Showers early, cloudy. High 63-68, low 53-58.

Tuesday: Sun returns, cool. High 59-65, low 52-57.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **B6.**

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The Trump administration reportedly seeks to create a panel that has the power to veto biomedical research grants that do not conform to its political agenda. **A4.**

Private health insurers covered 112,000 fewer Massachusetts

residents’ GLP-1 weight-loss drugs this year, according to a report. **D1.**

President Trump said drones and snipers could be housed on his proposed 250-foot arch of triumph in Washington, D.C. **A2.**

Iranian-backed Houthi rebels intensified their battles with fighters aligned with Saudi Arabia over territory in Yemen. **A3.**

The Red Sox backed into the playoffs, thanks to a loss by the Houston Astros. **C1.**

